THAILAND · 1–14 NOVEMBER 2026 · 14 DAYS · 2 TRAVELLERS

Up the rails, *down the coast*

BKK → Bangkok (EK374 · 07:35) — 2 NIGHTS → Chiang Mai — 3 NIGHTS → Krabi — 3 NIGHTS → Khao Sok — 3 NIGHTS → Bangkok — 1 NIGHT → BKK (EK373 · 20:45)

At a glance

NOVEMBER 2026

The whole trip on one grid — colour-coded by region, travel days flagged. You land Sunday the 1st and fly home Saturday the 14th.

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1 LAND 07:35	2 BANGKOK	3 NIGHT TRAIN	4 CHIANG MAI	5 U CHIANG MAI	6 U CHIANG MAI	7 FLY SOUTH
8 CENTARA	9 CENTARA	10 TRANSFER IN	11 360 ISSARA	12 360 ISSARA	13 FLY TO BKK	14 FLY 20:45

Bangkok · Chiang Mai · Krabi · Khao Sok · ✈ marks a travel / transit day

Bangkok — *arrival*

SUN 1 → TUE 3 NOV

Land at 07:35 and give yourself a soft start: temple-hop the old city, eat your way down the Chao Phraya, and shake off the flight before the night train north.

> **Use the Edit benefits — they're only on this stay.** Booking the Ritz through The Edit comes with **breakfast for two daily**, a **USD 100 property credit** (once per stay, and not against the room rate, tax or tips — so spend it on food, drinks or the spa), a welcome amenity, Wi-Fi, and a room upgrade plus **early check-in and late check-out, all subject to availability**. Ask for each at the desk; none of it is applied automatically. Chiang Mai and Krabi were booked through Chase Travel too, but neither carries these.

SUN
1
NOV

ARRIVE

Land & ease in

- **Take the rail in, don't queue for a taxi.** Clear immigration, then follow the signs down to the **Airport Rail Link** on the terminal's basement level: City Line to **Makkasan** (A6), about 25 minutes, **THB 35**. A **166 m covered skywalk** leads to **MRT Phetchaburi**; Blue Line towards Hua Lamphong, four stops to **Lumphini**, and Exit 1 opens onto a walkway into One Bangkok — 300 m to the door. Reckon on **45–50 minutes** and roughly THB 65 each, against 45 to 90 minutes in a taxi.
- Standard check-in is 15:00, but **early check-in is one of your Edit benefits** — ask at the desk and you'll likely get in after a 07:35 landing. If the room isn't ready, leave the bags and start the day anyway.
- Late morning: **Wat Pho** and its giant reclining Buddha, then a foot massage at the temple's own school.
- **20:00 — Manohra dining cruise**, booked and prepaid: a converted teak rice barge from the Anantara Riverside pier, up past **Wat Arun** and the Grand Palace lit from the water. Rail there too — MRT **Lumphini → Si Lom**, cross to BTS **Sala Daeng → Saphan Taksin**, then the free Anantara shuttle boat from Sathorn pier every 15 minutes. Be at the pier by **19:00**.
- **Confirm the boarding time** when you call about dietary requirements — the reservation reads 20:00, but Manohra's published cruise leaves 19:30 with check-in from 19:15. It's a late finish for a first night: back around 23:00, after 21 hours of travelling across a 12-hour shift. The cruise is **non-refundable**, so keep the afternoon soft and build the day around it.

STAY Ritz-Carlton · 90034653

→ ARR EK374 07:35 · H2M5FJ

⊟ RAIL ARL A1→A6 · MRT to Lumphini · ≈ 50 min

CRUISE Manohra 20:00 · YQGNYS

Edit — ask for early check-in

MON
2
NOV

CITY

Grand old Bangkok

- Open-of-day at the **Grand Palace & Wat Phra Kaew** (Emerald Buddha), before heat and crowds.
- Ferry across to **Wat Arun**; climb the central prang for the view.
- Afternoon: Jim Thompson House or a cool-down spa hour. Evening: **Yaowarat** Chinatown street-food crawl.

STAY Ritz-Carlton

MRT Lumphini 300 m

TUE

3

NOV

DEPART

Ayutthaya, then the rails

- **09:00 — private full-day tour of Ayutthaya**, booked and paid: ten hours, your own guide and car, and a build-your-own itinerary through the old capital's ruins. Pick-up from the Ritz lobby; TripGuru confirm the time a day or two ahead.
- **Check out before you go.** You leave at 09:00 and never come back — the room goes at 12:00 and late check-out is no use to you now.
- **Board Special Express #9 at Ayutthaya, not Bangkok.** Thai Railways confirmed it in writing: the train leaves **Ayutthaya at 19:45**. Your ticket is unchanged — you simply skip the first hour of it. Be on the platform by **19:15**; the stop is about two minutes long.
- **This all hangs on one unconfirmed thing.** The tour as sold returns you to the Ritz, and a ten-hour day from 09:00 ends at 19:00 — far too late for the 18:40 out of Bangkok. You've asked TripGuru to drop you at **Ayutthaya station** instead and to carry two backpacks for the day. **Get that in writing before 2 November**, which is also when free cancellation ends.
- Temple dress code applies at the ruins: shoulders, back and knees covered. Carry cash — the site fees aren't included, and there's no ATM on the platform.

⊟ TRAIN #9 Ayutthaya 19:45 → 07:15 · 34511470

TOUR Ayutthaya 09:00 · GYG996VK39Z9

confirm the station drop-off

SLEEPER #9 · TICKETED

STATE RAILWAY OF THAILAND · SPECIAL EXPRESS

19:45 — ≈ 11 h 30 — 07:15

AYUTTHAYA — overnight — CHIANG MAI

Joined here · Tue 3 Nov — Wed 4 Nov (+1)

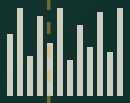
CLASS 2nd A/C sleeper × 2

REF …6901 / …6902

TICKETED KTW → CGM, boarded downline

NIGHT 03

Sleep on the move



On the platform by **19:15**. The stop is **2 min**.

02 / 05

Chiang Mai — *the north*

WED 4 → SAT 7 NOV

Wake up in the mountains. Lanna temples, an ethical elephant day, jungle waterfalls and cool air — the exhale after Bangkok's heat. Three nights at **U Chiang Mai**, inside the moat.

> **The room is booked from Tue 3 Nov**, the night you're on the train. That night is paid for deliberately: the room is already yours when you step off the sleeper at 07:15 on the 4th, so you walk in and check in on time whatever the train does. The rate is **non-refundable**, so the dates can't be shifted. Breakfast isn't included — about **THB 399** each for the buffet.

WED
4
NOV

ARRIVE

Off the train, into the Old City

- Arrive 07:15; the room is already held from last night, so go straight there and drop your bags.
- Temple wander on foot: **Wat Chedi Luang**, **Wat Phra Singh**, and the quiet lanes between.
- Afternoon: **Wat Phra That Doi Suthep**, the gold chedi on the mountain — an hour up, an hour back. **This is now its only slot**; the 5th and 6th are both full-day booked tours.
- Evening: the Night Bazaar and a bowl of **khao soi**, the north's signature curry noodle.

STAY U Chiang Mai · 2535552787

arr 07:15

THU
5
NOV

MOUNTAIN

Doi Inthanon, the whole day

- **08:30 — private full-day tour of Doi Inthanon**, booked and paid: Thailand's highest peak, the waterfalls and the twin royal chedis. English-speaking guide, air-conditioned car, hotel pick-up and drop-off, park and Twin Pagoda entrance fees all included. **Lunch isn't.**
- **Send TripGuru your WhatsApp number and the hotel name before 18:00 the day before**, or they'll pick you up at a meeting point instead of the hotel. They email the night before with the where and when.
- **They need passport name, number and date of birth for both of you** on their insurance form before the tour runs. Do it now, not on the day.
- Back by evening; unwind in **Nimman**, the café and craft-beer district.

STAY U Chiang Mai

TOUR Doi Inthanon 08:30 · 1444673351

send passport details ahead

FRI
6
NOV

ELEPHANTS

Elephants, done right

- **Elephant Highlands, a single-day visit to Elephant Nature Park** — booked, #55796. Hotel pick-up from U Chiang Mai between **08:00 and 08:45**; wait in the lobby and check your name with the driver, as not every van is badged.
- **THB 8,400 is still owed and must be paid in cash, in baht, at the start of the day.** Only the THB 3,600 deposit has gone through. Draw it in Chiang Mai the day before.
- Confirm the hotel as your pick-up point **at least 72 hours ahead** — otherwise you have to make your own way to their office on Ratmakka Road.
- It's a proper walking day: up to **3½ hours** on muddy mountainside. Take a change of clothes and shoes, a towel and repellent, in **one small day pack each**. Vegan lunch is included.
- Repack for the tropics tonight — tomorrow starts early.

STAY U Chiang Mai

TOUR Elephant Nature Park · 55796

THB 8,400 cash on the day

early start tomorrow — away by 06:00

Fly Chiang Mai → Krabi

CNX → KBV · FD3072 · direct · ticketed

Sat 7 Nov · morning
≈ 2 h in the air

03 / 05

Krabi — *the Andaman*

SAT 7 → TUE 10 NOV

Swap mountains for limestone and sea. Longtail boats, castaway beaches, and karst cliffs rising straight out of turquoise water. Three nights at **Centara Ao Nang**, on the beach.

> **You land well before check-in.** FD3072 puts you in Krabi at 09:55 and the room isn't ready until 15:00, so plan to leave the bags at reception and start the day on the beach. Two things worth asking the hotel for when you arrive: a room **away from the drainage canal** that runs between the wings — it's a known smell complaint — and confirmation of the pool-access room you booked. Rate is **non-refundable**; breakfast is extra, around **THB 325–650** each.

SAT
7
NOV

ARRIVE

Fly south, feet in the sand

- Morning flight down; transfer to **Ao Nang** — about 30 minutes from the airport.
- Afternoon on the beach, first Andaman sunset, a long seafood dinner.

→ FLY FD3072 CNX→KBV · UYTUHF

STAY Centara Ao Nang · 2535573436

SUN

8

NOV

ISLANDS

Nine islands, your own boat

- **Private longtail, eight hours**, booked and paid — the boat is yours rather than a shared seat, so the order and the pace are between you and the boatman.
- **Pick-up from the Centara lobby**, dropped back at the same place. **The time is still to be confirmed** — the operator rings within 48 hours of booking.
- **No guide and no meals are included.** Take cash for a beach lunch, plus water, sunglasses and reef-safe sunscreen — oxybenzone is banned in Thai marine parks.
- **Weather is still the risk, but the decision moved.** Free cancellation ends **09:00 on the 7th**, so check the forecast the moment you land in Krabi — after that the day is yours, rough or not.

STAY Centara Ao Nang

BOAT 9 Islands private · GYGVN22MBRVZ

pick-up time to confirm

MON
9
NOV

EXPLORE

Pools, steam & 1,260 steps

- **08:00 — small-group tour, nine and a half hours**, booked and paid. It does the lot: swim in the **Emerald Pool**, walk the **Blue Lagoon**, lunch, the **Hot Springs Waterfall**, then the **Tiger Cave Temple**. Guide, hotel pick-up, all entrance fees and drinking water included.
- **The 1,260 steps come last, not at dawn.** You climb them in the afternoon heat at the end of a long day — pace the rest of it accordingly.
- **Temple dress code is enforced.** No sleeveless shirts; shoulders, back and knees covered. Take a sarong or scarf you can throw on, plus swimwear, a towel and a change of clothes.
- Pick-up from the Centara lobby; they email the time **the evening before**. Be down **ten minutes early** — the guide carries a TripGuru sign and waits ten minutes, no more.

STAY Centara Ao Nang

TOUR Emerald Pool + Tiger Cave 08:00 · GYGN6BWWFQFY

cash for lunch

drive to Khao Sok tomorrow

Transfer Krabi → 360° Issara

included · private van from Centara Ao Nang · 500Rai Pier Office, Chiew Larn

Tue 10 Nov · pickup 09:00 · boat 12:00
≈ 2 h road + 1.5 h boat

04 / 05

Khao Sok — *on the lake*

TUE 10 → FRI 13 NOV

Three nights floating on Cheow Lan Lake at 360° Issara, ringed by limestone towers in one of the oldest rainforests on earth. The centrepiece of the trip.

Transfers are included and confirmed. The resort's van collects you from the Centara at **09:00** (~2 h) for the shared **12:00** boat from the 500Rai Pier Office, Chiew Larn — walk left on arrival; the office faces the Tourist Police. Pack small; big cases can stay at the pier office. Bring Thai cash: **THB 340 each** for the park fee and the **THB 3,500 room deposit**.

The way out is the tight one. The **10:30** boat on the 13th is confirmed and feeds a non-refundable flight, but the **van on to Surat Thani is not yet arranged**. Send the resort URT and SL741 16:40 at least 24 h ahead, with your picks for the **three included activities** — none is booked and places are limited. A/C runs **12:00–06:00 only**, all three nights.

TUE
10
NOV

ARRIVE

Drive, then the longtail

- The resort's van collects you from the Centara at **09:00** — it's about **2 h by road** to Chiew Larn, which leaves time at the pier for the park fee and getting bags down to the boat before **12:00**.
- **1.5 h by longtail** across the lake, sightseeing on the way; the resort appears like a floating village.
- Check in from 14:00, swim off the deck, set dinner over the water. **17:00**: wildlife safari & sunset cruise, about an hour by longtail around the resort, no guide. Activity one of three. Miss the 12:00 boat and the next is 15:30, which costs you this.

STAY 360° Issara · 0592406

Deluxe Triple · 3-Night Essence

WED
11
NOV

THE LAKE

Nowhere to be

- **Prakai Petch Cave Trail**, **09:45–12:45** — swamp forest, small waterfalls, glittering cave. It runs Mon/Wed/Sat only, so today is the one chance, and it's only offered on the 3-Night Essence package. Activity two of three. The one fixed thing today.
- After that, nothing: kayak straight off your own balcony — each room has one.
- Swim in the fresh water, read, watch the light move across the karsts.

STAY 360° Issara | A/C 12:00–06:00 only

THU
12
NOV

DAWN

Last full day on the water

- **Pakarang Cave Trail**, **09:45–12:45** — 1.5 km trek, a 10-minute bamboo raft to the cave, back the same way. Run with 500Rai and **must be booked in advance**. THB 200 each entrance, cash on site. Activity three of three.
- Afternoon on the deck; gibbons, hornbills and elephants are about along the shoreline.
- Last sunset cruise at 17:00 — but that would be a fourth activity, so **ask the resort whether it's included** or charged. Pack tonight — **check-out is 10:00**.

STAY 360° Issara | check-out 10:00

Boat, car, then fly → Bangkok

360° Issara → Chiew Larn → Surat Thani (URT) → Don Mueang (DMK)

Fri 13 Nov · boat 10:30
SL741 16:40 → 17:55

Bangkok — *the finale*

FRI 13 → SAT 14 NOV

One night back in the capital at **Grande Centre Point Terminal 21**, on the Asok interchange, then a half-day in the city — check-out at noon, bags at the desk, and the 20:45 flight to make.

FRI
13
NOV

RETURN

Off the lake, into the city

- Breakfast, check out at 10:00, scheduled boat at 10:30, car to Surat Thani — at URT about 13:00.
- **SL741 16:40 → 17:55** into **Don Mueang, Terminal 2** — roughly three hours in hand at Surat Thani.
- **Take the SRT Red Line** to Krung Thep Aphiwat, then the MRT to Sukhumvit. It's a Friday and the roads will be at their worst; the train is elevated and ignores them. Reckon on being checked in around 19:00–19:30.
- Dinner around **Terminal 21** — the hotel sits on top of the Asok interchange, so you needn't go far.

→ FLY SL741 URT→DMK 16:40 · OWUPXU

STAY Grande Centre Point T21 · 73523066938869

SAT

14

NOV

DEPART

Fly home

- Check out at 12:00 and leave the bags at the desk. You have five hours, so keep it central — **ICONSIAM**, Jim Thompson House, a last massage. Nothing that needs the better part of a day — and you did Ayutthaya on the 3rd anyway.
- Leave by **17:00** for Suvarnabhumi. From Asok it's one MRT stop to Phetchaburi and straight onto the **Airport Rail Link at Makkasan** — about 30 minutes, and no traffic to allow for.
- **20:45**: EK373 to Dubai, then JFK at 08:15 Sunday.

→ DEP EK373 20:45 · H2M5FJ

at airport by ~17:45

Before you go

01 **Train #9 is ticketed, but you join it at Ayutthaya.** Two 2nd-class A/C berths (res. 34511470). The ticket reads Bangkok 18:40 → Chiang Mai 07:15; you board at **Ayutthaya at 19:45** instead, which Thai Railways confirmed in writing. The berths are yours either way.

02 **Booked.** Emirates H2M5FJ, Ritz-Carlton (90034653), Sleeper #9, U Chiang Mai (2535552787), FD3072 (UYTUHF), Centara Ao Nang (2535573436), 360° Issara (0592406), SL741 (OWUPXU), Grande Centre Point T21 (73523066938869). All thirteen nights and every flight are now booked. The Krabi transfer is confirmed; the van to Surat Thani isn't yet. Six activities are booked too: the **Manohra dinner cruise** on the 1st (YQGNYS), **Ayutthaya** on the 3rd (GYG996VK39Z9), **Doi Inthanon** on the 5th (1444673351), **Elephant Nature Park** on the 6th (55796), the **9 Islands private longtail** on the 8th (GYGVN22MBRVZ) and **Emerald Pool & Tiger Cave** on the 9th (GYGN6BWWFQFY). Still open: the three included activities at Khao Sok.

03 **Timing is good, not guaranteed.** Early November is the front edge of the cool, dry season, and Khao Sok is at its lushest because the rain has only just stopped. The Andaman is still drying out — expect a wet afternoon or two. The island day used to be the one to move; now it's booked, so that call has to be made by **09:00 on the 7th**, while cancelling is still free.

04 **Mind the two airports.** You arrive on the 13th at **Don Mueang** but fly home on the 14th from **Suvarnabhumi**. There's no connection between them — you sleep in the city — but don't turn up at the wrong one on Saturday.

05 **Carry more cash than you think.** The elephant park wants its **THB 8,400 balance in baht on the morning of the 6th** — draw it in Chiang Mai the day before. Then THB 340 each at Khao Sok, THB 200 each for Pakarang and a THB 3,500 deposit.

06 **This is a shape, not a script.** The beds and the flights are fixed now, and non-refundable — but nothing inside a day is. Swap the order, drop what doesn't appeal, and bend the days to your energy.

DOWNLOAD ITINERARY (PDF)

DOWNLOAD CALENDAR (PDF, PRINT LANDSCAPE)

DOWNLOAD DOSSIER (PDF, LONG FORM)

// 14 days · 13 nights · Bangkok — Chiang Mai — Krabi — Khao Sok — Bangkok · Nov 2026